



Q2

Collect breach information from credible sources and summarise it

5 Marks

Objective: Gather verifiable facts about the breach from reputable public sources and write a short, neutral incident background.

Step-by-Step Algorithm

Step	Phase	Action	Command / Tool	What You Should See
1	SETUP	Identify 2–3 credible sources (vendor advisory, CISA, established news).	CISA / news / vendor blog	Source list
2	ANALYSE	Extract the key facts: who, what, when, how discovered, what data.	5W notes	Fact sheet
3	TEST	Cross-check each fact against a second source to avoid rumour.	Second source	Facts confirmed
4	ANALYSE	Note anything still unknown or disputed as an open question.	—	Open-questions list
5	REPORT	Write a 4–6 sentence neutral summary with citations.	Summary template	Incident background

Phase key: ● SETUP · ● CONFIGURE · ● EXECUTE · ● TEST · ● ANALYSE · ● REPORT · ● FINISH

Worked Example (with sample values & output)

Sample incident background (Acme HealthCare)

On 3 March, Acme HealthCare disclosed that attackers accessed its patient database after an employee opened a phishing email on 24 February. Roughly 50,000 records were exfiltrated and systems were encrypted with ransomware. The intrusion was detected when staff could not log in to the booking portal. The company engaged an incident-response firm and notified the data-protection regulator. (Sources: company statement; national CERT advisory.)

Fact	Detail
Who	Acme HealthCare (healthcare provider)
What	Phishing email leading to ransomware and data theft
When	Initial access 24 Feb; publicly disclosed 3 Mar
How discovered	Staff unable to log in to the booking portal
Data affected	~50,000 patient records
Sources	Company statement; national CERT advisory

Reusable Template

Yahoo Data Breach:

On 22 September 2016, Yahoo disclosed that attackers linked to a state-sponsored actor had stolen data from at least 500 million user accounts in a breach that occurred in late 2014. Three months later, on 14 December 2016, Yahoo disclosed a second, separate and earlier breach — dating back to August 2013 — originally reported as affecting over 1 billion accounts; in October 2017, under new owner Verizon, that figure was revised upward to all 3 billion Yahoo accounts. Both intrusions came to light during an internal investigation after stolen account data was found being offered for sale on a dark-web forum. Yahoo forced password resets, invalidated unencrypted security questions, and



notified affected users. (Sources: Yahoo 8-K/10-K SEC filings; US DOJ indictment, March 2017; Reuters and New York Times reporting.)

Fact-sheet template (copy and fill)

Fact	Detail
Who	Yahoo (global internet and email service provider)
What	Theft of user account data — names, email addresses, phone numbers, dates of birth, hashed passwords, and (for some accounts) unencrypted security questions/answers
When	Breach 1: ~August 2013 (disclosed Dec 2016). Breach 2: ~Late 2014 (disclosed Sep 2016)
How discovered	Internal investigation triggered after stolen Yahoo account data appeared for sale on a dark-web forum
Data affected	2013 breach: all ~3 billion accounts (revised Oct 2017, originally reported as 1B+). 2014 breach: ~500 million accounts

Your Output / Screenshot (paste result here):

- **Attribution:** In March 2017 the US DOJ indicted four individuals for the 2014 breach — two alleged FSB (Russian intelligence) officers, Dmitry Dokuchaev and Igor Sushchin, plus hackers Alexsey Belan and Karim Baratov — one of the first US indictments of state officials for cyber-enabled crime.
- **Business impact:** After the breaches were disclosed mid-acquisition, Verizon cut its offer for Yahoo's core business by \$350 million (from ~\$4.83B to ~\$4.48B) before the deal closed in 2017.
- **Regulatory penalty:** The SEC fined Yahoo \$35 million in 2018 for failing to disclose the 2014 breach to investors in a timely manner — one of the first SEC enforcement actions of its kind for breach-disclosure delay.
- **Legal settlement:** Yahoo agreed to a \$117.5 million class-action settlement (2019) to compensate affected users.
- **Open question / lesson:** The disclosed scope of the 2013 breach grew from "1 billion+" to "all 3 billion" accounts a full year after first disclosure — a good example of why Step 4 (flagging unknowns rather than assuming initial figures are final) matters in real reporting.